

The founder of the Institute for Philosophical Research, Dr. Mortimer J. Adler, was even more blunt: “The person who says he knows what he thinks but cannot express it usually does not know what he thinks.”

Knowledge is distributed widely in our society. We err when we believe this knowledge is our own understanding.



What happens when facts collide with our beliefs? Cognitive dissonance is the result. Let's find out how it hurts our returns.

[377](#) Nathan Ballantyne, “Epistemic Trespassing,” from Nathan Ballantyne, *Knowing Our Limits* (Oxford University Press, 2019). See also: Nathan Ballantyne, “Epistemic Trespassing,” *Mind*, vol. 128 (April 2019).

[378](#) Nathan Ballantyne “Epistemic Trespassing.”

[379](#) Matan Mazor and Stephen M. Fleming, “The Dunning-Kruger effect revisited,” [nature.com](https://www.nature.com) (April 8, 2021).

[380](#) Julia Bönisch, “Déformation professionnelle: Beruflich bedingte Missbildung,” *Süddeutsche Zeitung* (May 21, 2010).

[381](#) Mixingmemory, “The ‘Illusion of Explanatory Depth’: How Much Do We Know About What We Know?” *ScienceBlogs* (November 16, 2006).

[382](#) Stephen J. Dubner and Matt Hickey, “How to Change Your Mind,” *Freakonomics* (May 29, 2019).

[383](#) Steven Sloman and Philip Fernbach, *The Knowledge Illusion* (Pan Macmillan, 2018).